

The Capability Map

Everything a full marketing function has, scored against what 3HUE has — including what to deliberately not build.

HOW TO READ IT

61 capabilities across eight layers. The *Skip* column matters as much as the gaps: copying an enterprise function at this headcount is how small teams drown.

PRIORITY

15 items are marked *Do first*. If only those get done, the function works. The rest is depth, not survival.

RE-RUN IT

Quarterly. Statuses move, and the honest value of this document is watching the gap count fall rather than admiring the map.

9

Have

Built and documented

12

Partial

Specified but not operating

33

Gap

Nothing exists yet

7

Skip

Deliberately out of scope

01 The three that actually matter

Out of the gaps below, three are structural rather than cosmetic — they undermine the strategy rather than merely leaving it incomplete. Everything else can wait a quarter.

1. There is nothing holding the prospects who aren't ready yet

The whole thesis is that organizations buy at a trigger. The fit model is built on it, and it correctly says that a prospect without one is a Tier C — decline or refer. But that means **at any given moment most of the ICP is unqualified**, and today they are declined and lost.

The trigger for a company that isn't ready today will fire in six to eighteen months. Whether 3HUE is the call they make depends entirely on having stayed present in a way nobody has built — no nurture, no list, no signal monitoring on renewal dates,

funding announcements, first-security-hire job posts, PE platform acquisitions or exam actions, all of which are publicly observable. *Qualifying out is only smart if something catches the people you qualified out.*

2. There is no narrative pitch deck

The single most-used asset in a consulting firm, and it does not exist as a template or an approved narrative. Every pitch is currently rebuilt from memory, which means the argument that took all this work to settle is re-invented — slightly differently — on every call.

This is also the cheapest thing on the list to fix now that the Message Stack exists. The narrative is written; it needs designing into fifteen slides.

3. The expansion motion is undefined, and it is the business model

The Snapshot is the entry point to every other offer. Nothing defines how a Snapshot becomes a managed programme — no handoff, no timing, no proposal moment, no measured conversion rate.

Without it, 3HUE is a paid assessment practice with a good pipeline rather than a managed services firm with an annuity. That distinction is the difference between the two business models, and it is currently left to chance on each engagement.

Two runners-up worth naming. AiVRIC publishes MSP partner tiers and a white-label motion with no channel marketing behind it — an entire revenue line with no demand programme, in a year when two-thirds of MSPs are trying to add exactly this capability. And the outreach sequence needs CAN-SPAM handling, plus GDPR or CASL if any prospect sits in the EU, UK or Canada. A firm that sells compliance sending non-compliant cold email is a story that writes itself.

02 The full map

Eight layers. Filter by status to see only what is missing, only what exists, or the list of things not worth building at this size.

SHOW

All

Gaps

Partial

Have

Skip

61 of 61 shown

Strategy & planning

Where the function points itself. Cheap to do badly, expensive to skip.

● HAVE **ICP & segmentation**

The Forcing Function — three ranked segments, 100-point fit model, personas, disqualifiers.

● HAVE **Claims substantiation discipline**

The Message Stack. Genuinely rare — most enterprise teams do not have this and get burned by it.

● PARTIAL **Competitive intelligence**

NEXT

Four battlecards exist. There is no ongoing programme — no pricing intel, no tracked wins and losses against named competitors.

● PARTIAL **Market definition & sizing**

LATER

Category-level data is in the research. There is no TAM/SAM/SOM for 3HUE's actual territory, which you need before any budget conversation.

● GAP **Buyer journey map**

NEXT

Triggers and personas exist but are not mapped to stages with content assigned. This is what tells you which asset is missing at which moment.

● GAP **Win/loss programme**

DO FIRST

Nothing. This blocks validating the fit model and is the highest-value data 3HUE could start generating this week at zero cost.

● GAP **Annual plan & quarterly OKRs**

LATER

Reasonable to run without for a quarter. Not reasonable for a year.

● GAP **Marketing budget model**

LATER

Needed once paid media starts. Not before.

● SKIP **Category design / category creation**

An enterprise play requiring years and millions. 3HUE competes in an existing, well-understood category. Deliberately skip.

Brand

Identity and the rules that keep it intact as more hands touch it.

● HAVE **Visual identity system**

Brand Sheet — logo system, colour with contrast analysis, type, UI tokens.

● HAVE **Verbal identity & naming**

Brand Sheet — voice attributes, tone by context, naming conventions.

● HAVE **Usage rules**

Brand Sheet — clear space, minimum sizes, backgrounds, co-branding, don'ts.

● GAP **Asset library**

NEXT

No single source of truth for logo files, templates or imagery. Today the answer to "where is the logo?" is "ask someone." A shared drive with a folder convention is enough — do not buy a DAM.

● GAP **Templates: deck, proposal, doc, social, signature**

DO FIRST

Inventoried in the Brand Sheet, none built. The slide template is the highest-frequency branded surface a consulting firm has and the most common place identity falls apart.

● PARTIAL **Trademark register**

LATER

Five AiVRIC product names carry TM, which is legal without registration. Worth confirming whether registration is intended before the names accumulate equity.

● SKIP **Brand governance & approvals**

At this headcount the approval process is Andrew reading it. Formalise when there are more than three people writing.

● SKIP **Brand purpose / values exercise**

A workshop industry. The voice work in the Brand Sheet does the useful part of this.

Messaging & content

What gets said, and the machine that keeps saying it.

● HAVE **Messaging framework**

The Message Stack — narrative, positioning, pillars, per-segment messaging, objections, battlecards, boilerplate.

● PARTIAL **Content strategy & calendar**

NEXT

A six-post pilot series exists. That is a test, not a strategy — there is no pillar-to-content map and no calendar beyond it.

● GAP **SEO keyword map**

DO FIRST

The symptom is documented — NIST, ISO 27001, CIS and SOC 2 appear nowhere public on 3hue.net — but no keyword-to-page map exists. This is the cheapest durable demand channel available and it is entirely unbuilt.

● PARTIAL **Thought leadership programme**

NEXT

Andrew has eleven published articles and a real point of view. There is no cadence, no distribution plan and no repurposing — one article currently produces one asset.

● PARTIAL **Customer evidence programme**

DO FIRST

Three stories published, rebuild spec written, but no consent process and no reference list. Consent is the long pole and nobody is asking for it at the moment engagements succeed.

● GAP **Review-site presence**

NEXT

No G2, Clutch or Gartner Peer Insights presence. For a buyer who cannot verify a services firm any other way, third-party reviews do work a website cannot.

● GAP **Speaking & events**

NEXT

High fit for a founder-led firm with a genuine practitioner record, and cheap. One well-chosen ISACA or regional CISO event beats a quarter of paid media.

● SKIP **Analyst relations (Gartner/Forrester)**

Six figures and a multi-year commitment to influence a buyer who is not reading Magic Quadrants at this deal size. Practitioner communities are the better spend.

● SKIP **PR & media relations**

Low return at this stage. Revisit if there is a genuine news event.

Demand generation

Turning the message into pipeline. The weakest layer by a distance.

● PARTIAL Campaign architecture

NEXT

One campaign built end to end in *The Ship List*. No campaign calendar, and nothing for the other five triggers.

● GAP Nurture for non-triggered prospects

DO FIRST

The structural gap. The entire thesis is that buyers act at a trigger — which means most of the ICP is unqualified at any given moment. Today those prospects are declined and lost. There is no mechanism to stay present until their trigger fires.

● GAP Trigger detection & signal monitoring

DO FIRST

The other half of the same hole. Renewal dates, funding announcements, first-security-hire job posts, PE platform acquisitions, exam actions — all publicly observable, none monitored. Detection is what makes nurture convert instead of drift.

● GAP Partner & channel marketing

DO FIRST

AiVRIC publishes MSP partner tiers and a white-label motion with no marketing behind it. That is an entire revenue channel with no demand programme, in a market where two-thirds of MSPs are actively trying to add this capability.

● GAP Marketing automation platform

NEXT

No known MAP. Required before nurture is possible at any scale beyond a spreadsheet.

● GAP Paid media

LATER

LinkedIn to a defined ICP list is the obvious first test, but only after the landing page and tracking exist. Spending before then buys noise.

● GAP Organic / SEO execution

NEXT

Follows the keyword map.

● GAP Webinars

LATER

Works in this category, but only with an audience to invite. Sequence it after nurture exists.

● GAP **ABM for Hue 02 and 03**

LATER

The portfolio and regulated lists are small enough to work by hand. Do it manually before buying anything.

● PARTIAL **Lead scoring & routing**

NEXT

The fit model is the scoring logic and it is sound. It is not implemented anywhere a lead actually lands.

Product marketing

Packaging what is sold, and arming the people selling it.

● HAVE **Competitive battlecards**

The Message Stack — four alternatives including doing nothing, which wins most often.

● PARTIAL **Offer architecture & packaging**

NEXT

Four offers defined in *The Ship List* with a clear entry point. Packaging is not documented anywhere client-facing.

● GAP **Pricing strategy**

DO FIRST

Andrew's decision, and it blocks the one-pagers, the website and the proposal template. Buyers in the research explicitly rewarded transparency and noted almost nobody offers it.

● GAP **Launch process**

NEXT

AiVRIC has four modules in beta, alpha or roadmap and no defined launch motion. Without one, in-development features leak into sales conversations as though they shipped.

● GAP **Voice of customer programme**

NEXT

One round of research is not a programme. Even four structured client conversations a year would beat re-reading this research in twelve months.

Sales enablement

The bridge. Where marketing work either converts or evaporates.

● HAVE **Discovery script**

The Ship List — eleven questions mapped to the fit model, with red flags and a qualify-out script.

● HAVE **Objection handling**

The Message Stack — eight objections drawn from what buyers say publicly.

● GAP **Narrative pitch deck**

DO FIRST

Missing and high-frequency. The single most-used asset in a consulting firm and there is no template and no approved narrative version. Every pitch is currently rebuilt from memory.

● PARTIAL **Offer one-pagers**

DO FIRST

Content and structure specified in *The Ship List*; not designed or built. Blocked partly on the pricing decision.

● GAP **Proposal & SOW template**

DO FIRST

Should carry the brand, the boilerplate, and standing scope and liability language. Its absence is a legal exposure as much as a marketing one.

● GAP **ROI / business case calculator**

NEXT

The whole pitch is "price this against the blocked deal." Nobody has built the arithmetic that lets a buyer show that to their CFO. High value, low effort.

● GAP **Reference programme**

NEXT

One buyer willing to take a call is worth more than three anonymous case studies.

● GAP **CRM stage definitions & sales SLA**

DO FIRST

Without stage definitions there is no win/loss data, and without win/loss the fit model cannot be validated. Small task, large downstream effect.

Operations & measurement

The plumbing. Unglamorous, and everything factual depends on it.

● PARTIAL **Measurement plan**

NEXT

Six measures defined in *The Ship List*. None instrumented.

● GAP **Analytics access (Search Console, GA)**

DO FIRST

Fifteen minutes of work, currently blocking every factual statement about the website. Do this before the landing page ships, not after.

● GAP **MarTech stack audit**

NEXT

Nobody has written down what actually exists — CRM, email, CMS, forms. You cannot plan around an unknown stack.

● GAP **Website operations**

NEXT

Unclear who can publish a page and how fast. That governs campaign speed more than any creative decision.

● GAP **Marketing data privacy compliance**

DO FIRST

Credibility risk. The outreach sequence needs CAN-SPAM handling, and GDPR or CASL if any prospect sits in the EU, UK or Canada. A firm that sells compliance sending non-compliant cold email is a story that writes itself.

● PARTIAL **Accessibility standard**

LATER

Contrast failures are documented in the Brand Sheet but no standard has been adopted. Matters more once a public-sector or regulated buyer audits the site.

● SKIP **Multi-touch attribution**

Meaningless at this deal volume. "How did you hear about us?" on the form is more accurate and free.

Customer marketing

After the sale. Where the business model actually lives.

● GAP **Expansion motion: Snapshot to programme**

DO FIRST

This is the business model. The Snapshot is the entry point to every other offer, and there is no defined motion for converting one into a managed programme. Without it, 3HUE is a paid assessment practice.

● GAP **Advocacy & reference generation**

NEXT

Should be triggered at the moment an engagement succeeds. Currently nothing asks.

● GAP

Onboarding communications

LATER

Sets the tone for the retainer relationship and reduces early churn.

● GAP

Satisfaction measurement

LATER

Even a single question at engagement close would be more than exists now.

● SKIP

Community building

Expensive, slow, and not where this buyer is. Participate in existing practitioner communities instead of building one.

03 What to do with this

The gap count is high on purpose — that is what a full enterprise inventory looks like against a firm this size, and most of it is fine. Three sequencing rules keep it from becoming a to-do list nobody finishes.

RULE	WHY
Do the <i>Do first</i> items, then stop and run for a quarter	The function works with those in place. Adding depth before anything has run produces documents rather than pipeline — and there are already five reference documents for a team this size to absorb.
Fix instrumentation before creation	Analytics access, CRM stage definitions and win/loss capture are hours of work each and they make every later decision evidence-based instead of argued. They are also the only way the fit model ever gets validated.
Let the skips stay skipped	Analyst relations, attribution modelling, community building, category design and brand-purpose work are where small teams spend a year and get nothing. They are marked skip on purpose; revisit only when headcount or deal size genuinely changes.

One thing this map cannot tell you. Whether the segmentation is right. That answer lives in won-lost data 3HUE has not captured yet, and it is why *win/loss* and *CRM stage definitions* are marked *Do first* despite being the least interesting items on the list. Re-score twenty closed deals against the fit model; if the tiers do not separate wins from losses, the weights move — not the segment definitions.

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